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FUTILE SEARCH FOR RARE MOMENT OF CALM IN A SEASON OF FLUX

With only two home Tests scheduled in the next year — against the West Indies in October — it wouldn't be surprising if the current core of India's Test side has played its **last home game together** in the longest format.

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India's storied legacy in Tests at home unravelled, layer by layer, over the course of a three-match series against New Zealand. A near-spotless record was systematically dismantled over three defeats, each inflicting a gaping wound that exposed a deeper malaise within the Indian Test setup and left a scar that would require an extensive post-mortem.

A misreading of the conditions in Bengaluru led to India conceding a Test at home to the Kiwis for the first time in 36 years, and meek surrenders on rank-turners in Pune and Mumbai saw Rohit Sharma's men snap an 18-series-long unbeaten streak and concede a clean

sweep in a three-match series at home for the first time, respectively.

If that wasn't enough, the 0-3 humiliation also left India gasping for air in the World Test Championship (WTC) standings. Heading into the series, India was sitting high and mighty atop the WTC points table. But the chastening series defeat nullified most of its advantage, forcing India into a must-win territory in the

